Community Services Committee Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

2nd Floor Arthur Horne Building
104 Ribaut Road
Beaufort, SC 29902

Monday, November 3, 2025
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/360099**

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Bartholomew called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair David Bartholomew
Committee Vice-Chair Thomas Reitz
Committee Member York Glover
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment

Absent
Committee Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Mark Lawson

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Bartholomew led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Bartholomew stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Tabernik, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Reitz to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

5. Public Comment Period

No public comments were taken.

6. Assistant County Administrator Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/360099**

7. Discussion Items

a. Presentation and Discussion of Emergency Medical Services hiring in order to implement a fourth shift. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Donna Owenby, Director of EMS and Karen Morris, EMS Training Officer

Donna Ownby and Karen Morris presented a PowerPoint about the status of hiring for fourth shift with Beaufort County EMS.

b. Presentation and Discussion concerning progress towards the solicitation of a Fire Service Consolidation Study. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - John Robinson, Assistant County Administrator of Public Safety

John Robinson, Assistant County Administrator of Public Safety, presented information on the fire safety consolidation study overview.

8. Agenda Items

a. Appointment of Justin Palmer to the Disabilities and Special Needs Boards for a four-year term with the expiration date of November 2029, pending approval by the Governor's Office. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Octavia Evans, Sr. Administrative Specialist

Motion: It was moved by Ex-Officio Howard, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the appointment of Justin Palmer to the Disabilities and Special Needs Board for a four-year term with the expiration date of November 2029, pending approval by the Governor's Office.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Bartholomew, Committee Vice-Chair Reitz, Committee Member Glover, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion passed 8:0.

9. Adjournment

Ratified: February 3, 2026